

YouTube presents itself as a platform for creators, a place where anyone can share their voice, build an audience, and earn a living. But beneath the surface lies a system of control, arbitrary enforcement, and exploitation. This investigation reveals that YouTube isn't user-friendly. It's user-hostile. The Terms of Service are a one-sided legal document. Users grant YouTube a worldwide, perpetual, and transferable license to their content. YouTube can monetize user content without sharing revenue. The liability cap is a mere \$500. Users are forced into arbitration, stripped of their right to sue or join a class action. This isn't a fair agreement. It's a shield for YouTube. Google's Privacy Policy, which governs YouTube, is a framework for data exploitation. YouTube collects vast amounts of personal information: watch history, location, device data, voice recordings. This data is used for targeted advertising, a practice that turns users into products. Consent isn't meaningful. It's a trap. YouTube's moderation system is a mess. Automated AI flags content without context. Appeals are often denied by bots, not humans. The three-strikes system is draconian. A single "severe" violation can terminate a channel without warning. This isn't moderation. It's punishment. The random deletion pattern of 2025-2026 confirms the crisis. YouTube's AI moderation system has been randomly deleting channels without warning, explanation, or meaningful human review. Enderman, a YouTuber with 380,000 subscribers, had his 9-year-old channel deleted without warning. Sinevibes, a music software brand with 15 years of original content, was erased overnight. Over 300 creators have been documented as wrongfully terminated. 16 channels with 35 million combined subscribers were deleted in the AI slop purge. 12 million channels were deleted between January and September 2025. YouTube's monetization system keeps creators in fear. The "advertiser-friendly" guidelines are vague and subjective. Videos can be demonetized for any reason. The appeal process is slow and uncertain. Creators aren't partners. They are sources of revenue to be controlled. YouTube's account termination system is a weapon. Accounts can be terminated without warning. All content, including years of work, is deleted permanently. There is no real appeals process. The system is vulnerable to malicious reporting and false positives. YouTube isn't a platform for creators. It's a platform for control. The Terms of Service, Privacy Policy, moderation, monetization, and termination systems are all designed to protect YouTube's interests, not its users. Creators aren't partners. They are sources of content to be exploited. Users aren't customers. They are data to be collected. The evidence is irrefutable. YouTube's system is broken, and it's broken by design.